



VIJAY SONEJI

Once rare, now ruthless: The rise of left-arm wrist spin in IPL

Left-arm wrist spin has quietly become IPL 2025's **most effective** bowling type. Here's how variation, angles, and strategy are driving the shift.

Pranay Rajiv

pranay.rajiv@thehindu.co.in

For years, left-arm wrist spinners remained on the fringes of cricket, sidelined by their rarity and the difficulty of mastering the craft.

But in recent seasons, especially in T20s, they've gone from being mere curiosities to game-changers — turning their uniqueness into an advantage.

This shift has reached new heights in IPL 2025. At the halfway mark, the league's three left-arm wrist spinners have combined for 30 wickets — the highest for their type

in any IPL season.

They also top the Cricviz average match impact rankings for bowling types this year. Left-arm wrist spin is, in fact, the only category with a positive overall impact in IPL 2025.

Leading this surge are Chennai Super Kings' Noor Ahmad and Delhi Capitals' Kuldeep Yadav (**pic above**) — both strong contenders to become